

THE OFFICIAL PUBLICATION FOR STUDENTS AND ASSOCIATES

THE INNOVATOR

FEU ALABANG | FEU DILIMAN | FEU TECH

VOL 1 ISSUE 2



INNOVATIVE NEW PROGRAMS

STUDENT MEDIA ORGANIZATIONS

FEU Tech
The Innovator

FEU Alabang
The Green Herald
The Visionary

FEU Diliman
The Innovator Jr.
Lumiere

INTERNS S.Y. 2024 - 2025

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REELS

FEU TECH'S ENGINEERING DEGREES ARE NOW RECOGNIZED

Big news, future engineers!

FEU Tech has been named a **Tier 1 Engineering Institution** by the **Philippine Technological Council (PTC)**, which places the institution on the same level as top engineering schools worldwide.

All five (5) of our PTC-accredited programs—**Civil, Electrical, Electronics, Computer, and Mechanical Engineering**—are now part of the **Washington Accord**, an international agreement that recognizes engineering degrees in countries like the US, Canada, Australia, and the UK.

For our students and future graduates, this means:

- ✓ A globally recognized degree
- ✓ International opportunities for careers, licensure, and graduate study
- ✓ A world-class engineering education

Moreover, being under the Washington Accord assures all FEU Tech graduates are held to the same standards as those from top global institutions, giving them a competitive edge wherever they go. This is more than just an institutional milestone, but a game-changer for every FEU Tech Engineering student.



ERING DEGREES ED INTERNATIONALLY

And the momentum doesn't stop there

FEU Tech proudly announces the successful accreditation of its engineering programs by the Philippine Accrediting Association of Schools, Colleges and Universities (PAASCU)—a testament to our continued commitment to academic excellence and innovation in engineering education.

These recognitions affirm that FEU Tech not only meets but in many aspects exceeds the rigorous benchmarks of quality education, faculty competence, industry relevance, research productivity, and student support services as set by one of the country's most respected accrediting bodies.

Accreditation Levels Achieved:

- ✓ **Level III:** Computer Engineering and Civil Engineering
- ✓ **Level II:** Electrical Engineering
- ✓ **Candidate Status:** Mechanical Engineering and Electronics Engineering

A PAASCU accreditation is more than just a seal of quality—it's a continuous commitment to improvement. It ensures that our curriculum stays relevant, forward-looking, and responsive to the rapidly evolving demands of engineering and technology worldwide.



FEU ALABANG

Accounting Students

WIN 3RD PICPA RESEARCH PAPER PRESENTATION



Showcasing academic excellence rooted in Fortitude, Excellence, and Uprightness, the Tamaraws made their mark at the 3rd Philippine Institute of Certified Public Accountants (PICPA) Accounting Research Paper Presentation. The research paper, "Career Attractiveness of Academic Sector of the Accountancy Profession among Certified Public Accountants in Metro Manila," penned by Allyssa Arma, Celarsieno Carolino, Kevin Pascual, and Kimberlee Juan, earned the 2nd Best Paper award.

In a double win, the team also secured the 2nd Best Presenter award at the event. The recognition in this prestigious professional forum validates academic quality, the students' holistic capabilities, and the institution's commitment to producing well-rounded and high-caliber graduates.

Business Administration Student Achieves **TOP 6 Certification**

FEU Diliman Business Administration
major in Marketing Management and
Multimedia Design student secures
**TOP 6 at the Certified Marketing
Management Specialist Assessment
Examination this May 2025!**

The Tamaraw community proudly
celebrates **Abigail Maurice Osorio!**
This notable recognition validates the
profound understanding of marketing
management principles and Osorio's
adherence to industry-leading ethical
standards. Her success is a direct
reflection of the high-caliber
education and practical training
students receive at FEU Diliman —
clearly indicating that this institution
commits to providing the **rigorous
curriculum and real-world exposure**
that enable students to translate their
learnings into tangible achievements.



11TH TOPCIT TOPNOTCHERS THREE-TIME TOP 1 PLACERS

FEU Tech, Celebrate Years at the TOP of TOPCIT

Manila, Philippines - FEU Tech has once again proven its excellence in Information Technology. For the third consecutive year, the College of Computer Studies and Multimedia Arts (CCSMA) has proudly secured the top ranks in the **Test of Practical Competency in Information and Communications Technology (TOPCIT) Philippines**.

This remarkable achievement follows FEU Tech's outstanding performances in the 9th and 10th TOPCIT for Philippine Higher Education Institutions, where our students also dominated the top spots.



The TOPCIT national exam, a collaborative initiative between the Commission on Higher Education (CHED) and the Institute for Information and Communications Technology Promotion (IITP) of the Government of South Korea. It serves as a crucial benchmark for practical ICT competency.

In the recently concluded **11th TOPCIT**, our exceptional **Information Technology** students demonstrated unparalleled skill and knowledge, clinching the most coveted positions:



TOP 1
Patrick Daniel Belarmino



TOP 2
Alea Anne Sari Dumo



TOP 3
Hans Christian Thompson



TOP 5
John Leo Raper

Leading The Future of Senior High Education SHS Strengthened Curriculum

FEU Alabang has been proudly selected by the Department of Education (DepEd) as a **pilot school** for the implementation of the **strengthened Senior High School (SHS) curriculum**, launching in School Year 2025–2026. This recognition reinforces FEU Alabang's position as a **trailblazer in progressive education**, a school that does not just adapt to change but leads it.



Why FEU Alabang

At FEU Alabang, innovation is not just a buzzword, it is a way of life. The institution's signature programs, CLICK (Coding, Creativity and Critical Thinking, Logic, Innovation, Character building, and Knowledge-based learning), Multiple Intelligence, and MILES (Mastery-based and Individualized Learning Enhancement System), are already aligned with the goals of the new DepEd SHS curriculum. These programs empower students with future-ready skills, ensuring they thrive in both academic and real-world settings.

A Curriculum That Matches the FEU Alabang Standard

The enhanced DepEd SHS curriculum streamlines learning into **core and elective subjects**, removing rigid strands and giving students the **freedom to explore their passions**. With only five core subjects and nine elective clusters, learners can now personalize their education, something FEU Alabang has long championed.



FEUture-Ready Facilities and Faculty

FEU Alabang is more than ready. With **state-of-the-art facilities**, **industry-aligned resources**, and a **faculty trained in modern pedagogies**, the school is fully equipped to deliver the new curriculum to the highest standard.

This makes FEU Alabang not just a participant in the pilot program—but a **model for excellence**.



A Smart Choice for **PARENTS and STUDENTS**

Choosing FEU Alabang means choosing a school that:

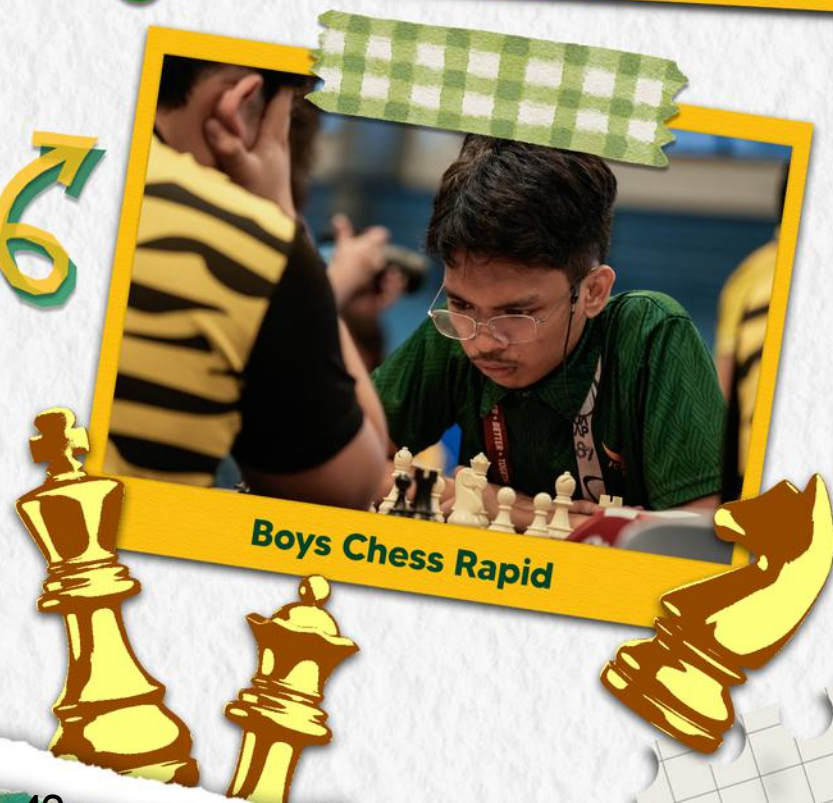
- ✓ Leads in educational innovation.
- ✓ Prepares students for college and careers.
- ✓ Offers a flexible, student-centered curriculum.
- ✓ Delivers quality education backed by a strong legacy.

As the education landscape evolves, FEU Alabang remains committed to its mission: to provide **globally competitive, value-driven education** that meets the demands of the future.

FEU DILIMAN UAAP SEASON 87 CHAMPIONS



Boys Basketball 3x3



Boys Chess Rapid



Boys Basketball



NEW PROGRAMS S.Y. 2025-2026

These three programs will be offered by the College of Computer Studies and Multimedia Arts.

FEU Tech Expands Its Innovation Frontier with Four Exciting New Programs

For years, FEU Tech has set the benchmark for pioneering education, continuously developing innovative, industry-relevant programs. By collaborating with top industry leaders and technology pioneers, the Institute ensures its curriculum remains ahead of the curve, preparing students for the most in-demand careers.

Building on the overwhelming success of its recent Cybersecurity and Artificial Intelligence specializations—fields experiencing unprecedented growth—FEU Tech now proudly introduces four future-forward undergraduate programs designed to equip students with cutting-edge expertise.



Bachelor of Science in CYBERSECURITY

With global cybercrime damages projected to reach \$10.5 trillion annually by 2025, the demand for cybersecurity professionals has never been higher. Building directly on the success of FEU Tech's recent Cybersecurity specialization, the BSCST program equips future experts with cutting-edge skills in ethical hacking, network defense, and digital forensics. Designed to safeguard critical infrastructures from ever-evolving digital threats, this program empowers students to become the cybersecurity leaders of tomorrow.

FEU Tech's commitment to innovation is evident in every facet of its curriculum. With these new programs, it has continuously anticipated emerging trends by integrating cutting-edge specializations that equip students with the skills needed for tomorrow's challenges.

Bachelor of Science in Financial Technology

As digital payments, blockchain, and AI-driven investments reshape global finance, the BSFINTech program offers an interdisciplinary approach that blends financial principles with advanced technological solutions. Students will explore blockchain innovation, algorithmic trading, and risk analytics, preparing them to drive the fintech revolution and redefine the financial landscape.



Bachelor of Science in Construction Engineering and Management

With rapid urbanization and the rise of smart infrastructure, the BSCEM program empowers future construction leaders with expertise in sustainable design, modern building technologies, and large-scale project management. By covering modern construction methodologies and sustainable practices, the program prepares future leaders to manage projects from inception to completion, ensuring robust and responsible urban development.

BSCEM will be offered by the College of Engineering.



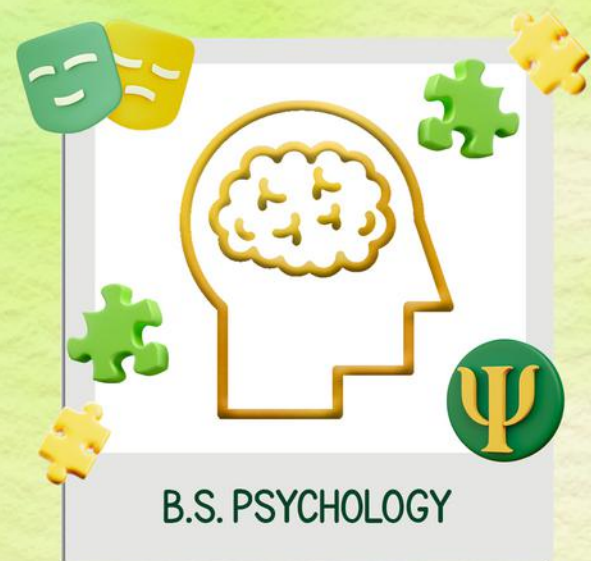
Bachelor in Digital Marketing and Management

In today's hyper-connected environment, digital marketing has become more strategic than ever. The BDMM program blends creative insight with data-driven analysis and covers key areas such as social media strategy, content creation, and digital analytics. The BDMM program meets the need for professionals capable of guiding brands through the complexities of the digital marketplace.



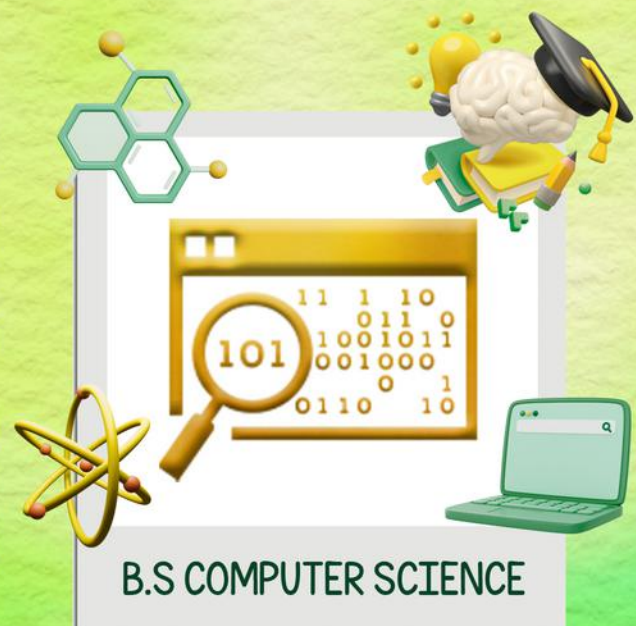
FEU Alabang and FEU Diliman expand Academic Programs with B.S. in Psychology and B.S. in Tourism Management for S.Y. 2025-2026

Responding to the escalating global and local demand for skilled professionals in mental health, clinical science, and psychological research and education, we've launched the B.S. Psychology program. This comprehensive four-year degree focuses on understanding human behavior and mental processes, cultivating graduates who are competitive and dedicated to improving mental well-being on both a global and local scale. By blending theoretical knowledge with practical application, students will delve into diverse psychological subfields. This ensures a rigorous academic foundation, positioning graduates to lead in addressing critical mental health challenges and advancing the field of psychology.



Meanwhile, the launching of the Tourism Management program is a direct response to the tourism sector's growing importance and integral role in the Philippine economy. With the industry actively recovering and evolving after the pandemic, there's a clear demand for skilled professionals adept at navigating this crucial domain. The curriculum, designed to blend academic depth with hands-on experience, integrates industry partnerships and real-world applications, preparing students not just for domestic and international roles but also to become key contributors who drive the nation's development.

In addition to these programs, FEU Diliman also offers the Bachelor of Science in Computer Science with Specialization in Software Engineering. This program addresses a critical demand in today's increasingly digital landscape. Graduates are uniquely positioned as innovative problem-solvers, adept at conceptualizing, building, and delivering secure, efficient, and high-quality software solutions that power modern life. Effectively, they serve as the architects and builders of the digital realm, employing a systematic and disciplined approach to create robust, efficient, and high-quality software solutions, guiding the entire process from initial design and development to rigorous testing and project management.





WALL OF



STUDENTS AWARDS, ACHIEVEMENTS

CHAMPIONS

FEU Tech SIKAPTala 2025: The National CS & IT Competition
CHAMPION of Computing and Information Systems Category



TOP INTERN

Ainslie Myart Marquez, B.S. Electrical Engineering student, was awarded as the Top Intern of FEU Alabang and FEU Tech engineering students' Intern's Closing Ceremony at SM Engineering Design and Development Corp. — one of the valuable industry partners of IALAP Office.



Java Programming



TAMARAW

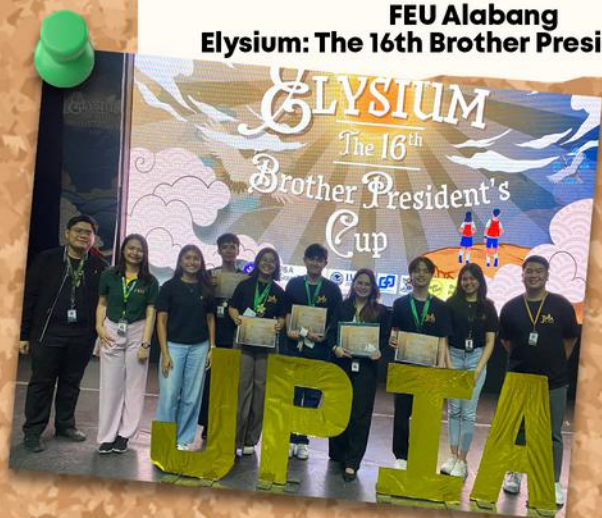
GREATS



EMENTS, AND RECOGNITIONS

WINNERS

FEU Alabang
Elysium: The 16th Brother President's Cup



2ND PLACERS

FEU Alabang secured the 2nd Place at the
Elysium: 16th Brother President's Cup

B.S. Accountancy student,
Jaiden Marcus Pajo, crowned
CHAMPION of the Accounting
Quizbowl Level 2 (FAR & RFBT)
at ELYSIUM



B.S. Accountancy student,
Ernest John Manalo, crowned
CHAMPION of the Accounting
Quizbowl Level 2 (FAR & RFBT)
at ELYSIUM



2ND PLACER

Fhaez Michael Almero of
FEU Tech, who was mentored
by **Engr. Mark Eullysis Alzaga**,
won **2nd place** at the
Broadcast ng Talino 2025



CHAMPIONS

FEU Tech Artist Connection Exude Dancers:
Champions of the Chosen Ground 18's College



PARTNERSHIPS &



FIT Group of Schools forges partnership with Malaysia Chamber of Commerce and Industries Philippines, Inc. (MCCI)! With the Memorandum of Agreement signed by the institutions, student internships, faculty immersion, research collaborations, and scholarships are possible between MCCI and FEU Tech, FEU Alabang, and FEU Diliman!

Signed by key leaders: MCCI President How Han Hui and executive directors from all three FEU campuses, this milestone solidifies a commitment to innovation, professional growth, and international collaboration.

With industry experts like QNE SOFTWARE MALAYSIA Chairman Sam Mun Loong and CSR & Sports Vice Chair Wei Win Tay present, this agreement signifies more than just a partnership, but a launchpad for future industry leaders.



Strategic partnership between FEU Tech and East Avenue Medical Center - DOH Eye Center continues

Following the impactful Online Clinical Registry project that advanced eye trauma research and decision-making, FEU Tech, through its **CCSMA Information System Development Unit (ISDTU)** and **Community Extension and Service Extension Office (CESO)**, is actively developing an innovative software solution to optimize DOH's daily operations. The collaboration implies FEU Tech's ongoing commitment to innovation and its expertise in Information Technology.

COLLABORATIONS



FEU Tech's courtesy visit and meeting with University of the Philippines Open University

Led by Dr. Juvy Lizette M. Gervacio, Director of the Center for Open and Digital Teaching and Learning, hosted a meeting, which was attended by FEU Tech's team led by Rossana T. Adao, Executive Director. They were also joined by Dr. Ace C. Lagman, Senior Director for Computer Studies and Multimedia Arts; Dr. Manuel Garcia, Director of the Educational Innovation and Technology Hub (EdITH); Samantha Sadorra, Director of Industry-Academe Linkage, Alumni, and Placement (IALAP); Geliza Alcober, Coordinator of the Information System Development and Training Unit; and Patricia Bianca Taculao-Deligero, also from the Educational Innovation and Technology Hub (EdITH).



MAYA President, Angelo Madrid, visited graduating students from Computer Studies, Information Technology, and Engineering gathered at the FEU Tech Boardroom for an insightful session.

The sit down with Mr. Madrid gave these Tamaraws a chance to gain career advice and a clearer path for growth in the tech world.

FEU Tech extends its gratitude to Angelo Madrid and the MAYA team for their time and expertise in inspiring the next generation of tech leaders.

Department of Finance Undersecretary Renato Reside Jr. visits FEU Tech

Joining the meeting focused on strengthening FEU Tech's Internship Program and exploring collaborative opportunities in Information Technology and Data Science were **Dr. Ace C. Lagman**, Senior for Computer Studies and Multimedia Arts; **samantha Sadorra**, Director of Industry-Academe Linkage, **Alumnim**, and **Placement (IALAP)**; and **Paulyn Garcia**, **Partnership Programs Coordinator**.





FEU Tech, through its Industry-Academe Linkage, Alumni, and Placement (IALAP) Office, is actively forging a strategic partnership with KPMG Philippines. Their recent meeting focused on developing a range of collaborative initiatives, including internship programs, faculty immersion, and broader partnership opportunities.

Present during the meeting were. **Chairman and KPMG Philippines CEO Sharon Dayoan with People, Performance and Culture Deputy Head Rico Baluyut, Assistants Larah Esclamado and Juliana Ragandan, Talent Management Associate KPMG Representative Richa Chaudhary.**

Meanwhile, attendees from FEU Tech were: Senior Director for Computer Studies and Multimedia Arts Dr. Ace Lagman, Senior Director for Engineering Romano Q. Neyra, Senior Director for Administration Jarvis C. Muyargas, Director of Industry-Academe Linkage, Alumni, and Placement (IALAP) Samantha Sadorra, and Partnership Programs Coordinator Paulyn Garcia.



IBPAP Talent Forum: Industry-Academe Link-Up-Colaborative Strategies for Workforce Development

The Talent Forum underscores the importance of industry-academe linkages in advancing workforce development within the IT-BPM sector. Aligned with the given theme, efforts are underway to identify schools that effectively align their academic programs with evolving industry demands through strategic collaboration.



The **Asian Institute of Technology (AIT)** in Thailand and **FEU Tech** formalized a partnership through a Memorandum of Understanding (MOU), paving the way for collaborative research, technology transfer programs, and master's degree opportunities for FEU Tech community and alumni; in turn, the shared commitment to academic excellence and innovation fosters knowledge exchange between the two institutions.

FEU Tech was represented by Ms. Rossana T. Adao, Executive Director; Mr. Jarvis Muyargas, Senior Director for Administration; Dr. Romano Q. Neyra, Senior Director for Engineering; Engr. Mylene Gomez, Director for Research; Ms. Samantha Sadorra, IALAP Director; and Ms. Paulyn Garcia, Partnership Programs Coordinator at IALAP.

Tamaraw Spotlight

Congratulations

**DANGAL NG BALIWAG
FOR EDUCATION**
awarded by the
City Government of Baliwag

Dr. Ace C. Lagman
Senior Director for
Computer Studies and Multimedia Arts



We proudly celebrate **Dr. Ace C. Lagman, Senior Director for Computer Studies and Multimedia Arts**, who has been honored with a **Dangal ng Baliwag (2025)**—a true testament to his unwavering dedication to shaping minds and commitment to excellence through education.

Dr. Lagman was the former President of Council of Deans in Information Technology Education (CODITE-NCR) and currently appointed as a member of Commission on Higher Education (CHED) Technical Panel for Information Technology (TPIT).

Dangal ng Baliwag is an annual recognition given by the City of Baliwag to outstanding individuals who have made exceptional contributions in their respective fields.

Dr. Manuel B. Garcia, Founding Director of the Educational Innovation and Technology Hub (EdiTH), has been appointed as an **Adjunct Professor at the Graduate School of Education, Korea University (Seoul Campus)** under the prestigious K-Club Program.

As part of this program, Dr. Garcia will collaborate with Korea University professors as well as leading researchers from 63 other countries with the common goal to foster global collaboration and drive innovation in education. His appointment is a testament to his academic contributions and a proud milestone for FEU Institute of Technology.



Congratulations

For completing a degree in
**MASTER OF ARTS
IN MULTIMEDIA ARTS**

Michael P. Camacho
Full-time Faculty, Multimedia Arts



Kudos to **Multimedia Arts full-time faculty Michael P. Camacho** on the successful completion of his **Master of Arts in Multimedia Arts**.

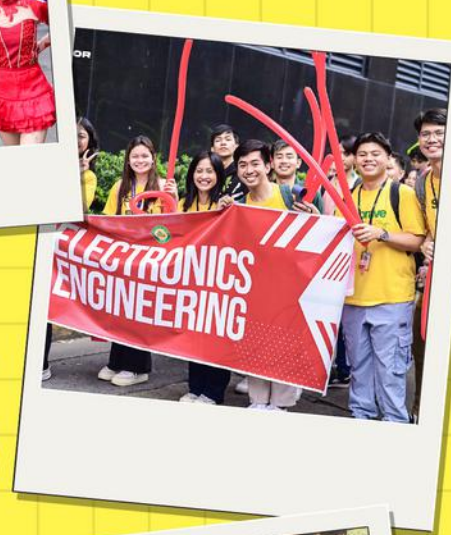
This achievement shows your commitment to academic excellence and your dedication to advancing your craft in the field of multimedia. Your hard work and perseverance are truly commendable.

Congratulations from FEU Tech and the Multimedia Arts Department, as we anticipate even greater achievements in your future.

EVENTS

FEBRUARY
07

Immersion in
FEU Alabang



FEBRUARY | FEU Tech
TechnoweeK
17-23

FEBRUARY
18

Ignite FEU Diliman
IGNITE 2025
exhibit



FEBRUARY
20

Ignite FEU Diliman
IGNITE 2025 exhibit



FEBRUARY
27

Immersion in FEU Alabang



ROUND-UP

**MARCH
11**

FEU Diliman's Star-up:
Dreams Unveiled,
Opportunities Defined,
and Zealously

**MARCH
15**

Immersion in FEU Alabang

MAY | FEU Tech
Women's Month

09

APRIL | SHS week FEU Alabang

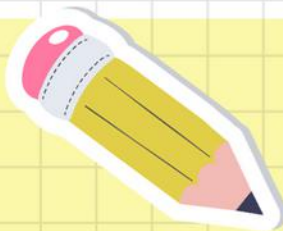
21-24

JUNE

19

FEU Tech ARTWAKENING FESTIVAL:
KOLAY PILIPINAS

23



Literary

A Tribute to a Leader

by **Abigail Alix**

Though trials faced she forged her way
With strength and grace she shone each day
Now blessed with all her dreams come true
She shares her light and she guides us through

A scholar once with hopes so bright
She faced each challenges and won each fight
And now she lifts those on their quest
Inspiring all to be their best

Her love for FEU Tech runs so deep
A promise strong she swore to keep
Within its walls she found her place
And grew with honor, strength and grace

Her career soared within these walls
She answered duty's noble calls
With fortitude, excellence, uprightness so pure
She leads with wisdom strong and sure

Oh, to a leader, bold and kind
A beacon bright and guiding mind
With love and faith your path shines bright
A guiding star, a steadfast light

***Abigail Alix is the Program Director of Multimedia Arts
and the Champion of the Poetry category for Associates.***

Featured this month are the winning entries from the Letters to Women competition organized by the English Resource Center and the Humanities, Social Science, and Communication Department, in collaboration with the FEU Tech Library in celebration of Women's Month at FEU Tech.

The women who conquer all

by Christian Joseph Novilunio

How long did it take for us to realize
That our other half should not be denied
Hundreds to a thousand years of endless cries
We turned our backs, your demands declined

From a spark to a roaring flame, you have become
Standing up to the injustice, despite the odds
And no longer can we blindly play dumb
To your endless shouts, and airtight bonds

Rights that were unalienable, given at long last
The fight, however, has not yet been won
Equality now the battle, you ever remain steadfast
Not ever resting, for there is work to be done

The adversity the other half must face with conviction
In a world so hostile to your very existence
And yet you stand tall against your opposition
Never cracking, the women's rights resistance.

Stand tall and be proud, our other half
Battered and beaten, but will never fall
Against all obstacles, you shall have the last laugh
A symbol of progress, an inspiration to all

***Christian Joseph Novilunio, a student of
BS in Information Technology with a specialization
in Computer Systems Technology is the
Champion of the Poetry category for Students.***

A Future Forged in Love and Resilience: A Mother and Daughter's Unyielding Spirit

by Jacklyn Anne C. Mantolino

We confirmed my pregnancy on February 11, 2023. Initially, we had mixed feelings, worrying about starting over and the risks of a late pregnancy, as I was already 43 years old then. However, as days passed, we learned to worry less and started to get excited. Seeing that tiny heartbeat was all we needed to embrace this journey with growing anticipation. Unplanned does not mean unloved; we knew our baby would be showered with as much love as our other children. We looked forward to welcoming our grandest and earliest Christmas gift in September. Or so we thought.

My journey to motherhood for the third time was filled with unexpected challenges, yet profound moments of love and resilience got us through. My story is one of those, a testament to the unyielding spirit of a mother and her daughter. It began with the birth of my daughter, Andy, who faced lifethreatening complications from her earliest days. This is our story of hope, faith, and the relentless fight for her survival.

From the moment Andy was born, she struggled to breathe. She was immediately placed in the Neonatal Intensive Care Unit (NICU), where she was put on Positive Pressure Ventilation (PPV) to help her breathe. The sight of my tiny baby connected to machines was heart-wrenching. I spent countless hours by her side, praying for her strength and whispering words of encouragement. Despite the initial improvements, Andy's condition remained critical: collapsed left lung, underwent surgery, intubated at 4 days old among other nightmares a parent could have for their child. Where such parent is a patient herself, recovering from a cesarean delivery.

In those early days, I learned the importance of breast milk for Andy's recovery. I started with just 1 milliliter of milk, expressing it by hand after watching countless videos on how to extract colostrum, my liquid gold. Gradually, my milk supply increased, and I was able to provide more for Andy. Each drop felt like a victory, a small but significant step towards her healing. Despite the stress and frustration, I persevered, knowing that my milk was vital for Andy's growth and recovery. I knew this liquid gold helped her live.

As the days turned into weeks, Andy's condition showed signs of improvement. She completed her course of antibiotics, and her vital signs stabilized. However, her platelet count dropped again, raising concerns about a possible fungal infection. The doctors conducted numerous tests, and while the initial results were promising, we anxiously awaited the final outcomes. Throughout this period, I clung to hope and faith, believing that Andy would overcome these challenges.

One of the most joyous moments came when Andy was finally able to latch onto me for breastfeeding, after 14 days of no skin-to-skin contact. The bond we shared during those moments was incredibly healing for both of us. It was a reminder of the strength of our connection and the power of a mother's love. Each feeding session brought us closer, both physically and emotionally, and helped boost my milk supply.

Despite the progress, there were still hurdles to overcome. Andy's weight fluctuated, and we needed to ensure she gained enough to be discharged from the NICU. Friends and family rallied around us, providing breast milk donations and emotional support. Their kindness and generosity were a lifeline during those difficult times. Slowly but surely, Andy's weight increased, and her overall health improved.

The journey was not without its frustrations. There were days when it felt like we would never bring Andy home. The constant worry and the emotional toll of seeing her in the NICU were overwhelming. Yet, through it all, we remained hopeful and trusted in the medical team caring for her. We knew that it was best to wait until Andy was truly ready to come home, even if it meant enduring more days of no sleep and receiving nerve-wracking messages from the NICU asking us to rush to the hospital.

Finally, the day came when Andy's platelet count rose to a healthy level, and she was cleared of any infections. Her weight had increased steadily, and she was feeding well. The doctors gave us the long-awaited news that Andy could soon be discharged. It was a moment of immense relief and joy, a testament to the power of love, resilience, and unwavering faith. Those were the 26 longest days of our lives as a family.

Bringing Andy home was a dream come true; it felt like Christmas Day. The journey had been long and arduous, but it had also been filled with moments of profound love and strength. Andy's survival was a testament to her unyielding spirit and the power of a mother's love. Our story is one of hope and resilience, a reminder that even in the face of the most daunting challenges, love and faith can forge a path to a brighter future.

As I reflect on our journey, I am filled with gratitude for the support we received from friends, family, and the medical team. Their prayers, encouragement, and generosity were instrumental in Andy's recovery. I am also reminded of the importance of perseverance and the strength that comes from within a mother's heart. Andy's fight for survival has taught me that even in the darkest moments, there is always hope.

My experience has inspired many around me, showing the strength and resilience that women possess. It represents the unyielding spirit of women who face challenges head-on and emerge stronger, shaping a brighter future for themselves and their loved ones. This story exemplifies the theme "Beyond Boundaries: Women Shaping the Future" by highlighting the journey of a mother who, despite facing immense challenges, demonstrates unwavering strength and resilience. It is a testament to how women can overcome obstacles and shape a hopeful future.

Our story is not just about overcoming medical challenges, not to mention almost a million pesos in medical costs; it is about the bond between a mother and her child. It is about the power of love to heal and the resilience that comes from facing adversity together. Andy's journey has shaped our future, one forged in love and resilience. As we move forward, I am committed to cherishing every moment with her and nurturing the unbreakable bond we share.

Jacklyn C. Mantolino is the Director of Human Resources and the Champion of the Essay category for Associates.

Letters to Women Who Inspire

by Princess Jamie Lozano

Dear Single Mothers,

How do I begin to tell the story of your strength? How can I possibly sum up the resilience, sacrifice, and relentless love that define you? It is an impossible task to single out just one woman, just one story, because your experiences are not borne in isolation—they are shared. **Womanhood**, in all its manifestations, is a collective endeavor, and single motherhood is one of its most demanding, formidable battlegrounds.

Society, however, often paints limitations around womanhood, binding us to archaic expectations and the rigid confines of outdated paradigms, measuring a woman's worth by the presence of a man in her life.

"Women are not strong enough. Women are not capable. Women require a man to lead them."

The whispers are loud, often shouted—cloaked in feigned concern but rooted in deeply ingrained prejudice. But single mothers—whether by choice or by circumstance—stand as a living repudiation of these narratives.

You are the embodiment of defiance against a world that insists upon defining your limits.

Yet, the world is rarely kind to you. There exists a distinct and pervasive scrutiny reserved for single mothers—a relentless interrogation of your worth, your choices, your very existence.

People assume your story before you are ever given the chance to tell it.

They label you as *reckless, irresponsible, a cautionary tale*. They question your competence, as if a woman's ability to nurture, to provide, to protect, could ever be contingent upon the presence of a man.

They say a woman cannot raise a child alone, that without a paternal figure, a child is doomed to be fractured, incomplete. They assert that a woman's limitations are intrinsic—that she is *too emotional, too fragile, too weak* to shoulder the weight of both parental roles.

They refuse to see the battles you fight daily, to acknowledge that the only thing greater than your burden is the strength with which you carry it.

And yet, you endure.

Many of you work long hours, juggling multiple jobs just to put food on the table. Others bid farewell to their children, entrusting them to relatives while crossing oceans and borders, enduring loneliness and homesickness, all for the hope of providing a better life.

You take on both parental roles, playing the comforting mother and the disciplinary father, making up for absences that you cannot control.

Every decision, every sacrifice, every difficult choice—you make alone, without a hand to hold or a shoulder to lean on.

And despite all of this, judgment still follows. There are still those who look at you with disdain, as if being a single mother is a failure rather than a testament to resolute love and perseverance.

They reduce you to statistics, to stereotypes, to cautionary anecdotes—your struggles oversimplified, your resilience overlooked, failing to see the immeasurable strength it takes to raise a child while carrying the weight of an unforgiving world.

I know this reality intimately because **I have lived as the child of a single mother.**

My father died before I was born. I never had the chance to know him, and before my family found stability, my mother was faced with an impossible choice—**stay and struggle or leave and fight for a future that could sustain me.**

So, she left. When I was still a baby, she joined three of her siblings in Dubai to work, to earn, to ensure that I would not grow up in need.

In her absence, I was raised by my grandmother, aunts, and uncles. They were the ones who saw my first steps, who comforted me when I cried, who became my world in those formative years.

And then, one day, **she returned.**

I didn't know how to acknowledge her, this woman who had given me life but had not been present in it. *She was a mother by title, but not by presence.*

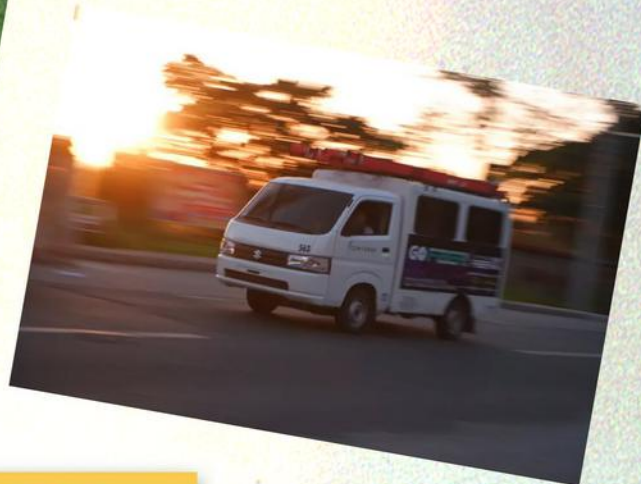
She was *a stranger with familiar eyes*, a silhouette of someone I should have known but did not.

*Princess Jaime Lozano, a student of
BS in Information Technology with a specialization
in Computer Systems Technology is the
Champion of the Essay category for Students.*

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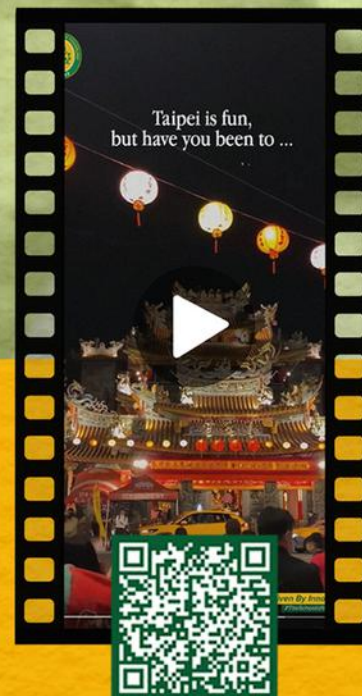


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